
Twin Synergy Telecommunications

NSF SBIR Phase I Budget Outline (Draft)

DRAFT FOR HIS RED PEN — NOT A SUBMISSION

Sol in Libra, 2026 e.v.
Johnathan 'Qasparr' (Κασπάρι) Monroe,
Keeper of the Secret Treasure

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Twin Synergy Telecommunications

"The budget is the plan expressed in money." — adapted from the standing maxim of grantcraft: a dollar without a task behind it is an unproved claim.

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Author: Johnathan 'Qasparr' (Κασπάρι) Monroe, Keeper of the Secret Treasure All Rights Reserved, Without Prejudice CashApp: \$axoneme

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- Phase I cap: ****\$305,000**** [VERIFIED FACT — NSF SBIR/STTR, current].
- Phase I duration: 6-18 months [VERIFIED FACT]; this budget assumes ****12 months**** [HYPOTHESIS].
- ****Every dollar figure below is [HYPOTHESIS] except the \$305,000 cap.**** Nothing here is a cost the company has actually incurred or committed to. The company is not yet formed — noted as in-progress under NSF's PI-primary-employment rule below.
- Tagging rule for this draft: [HYPOTHESIS] = number assumed, not measured; [VERIFIED FACT] = independently established.

A. Senior Personnel [HYPOTHESIS]

Role	Effort	Salary basis (annual, FTE)	Cost
PI — Johnathan 'Qasparr' Monroe	75% × 12 mo	\$95,000	\$71,250
Senior Network Engineer (TBD)	50% × 12 mo	\$85,000	\$42,500
A subtotal			**\$113,750**

Arithmetic: $0.75 \times 95,000 = 71,250$; $0.50 \times 85,000 = 42,500$; $71,250 + 42,500 = \mathbf{113,750}$.

Justification: The R&D tasks for Phase I — Tor/onion-service engineering, DID identity prototype, \$PPP/\$00 testnet, CALEA-compliance engineering, measurement of the DID sybil-detection rate — require one PI driving architecture full-ish time and one senior engineer executing the networking and cryptography work. The 75%/50% splits are [HYPOTHESIS]; see red-pen notes. The salary bases are [HYPOTHESIS] placeholders, chosen as conservative early-startup compensation, not market offers.

NSF rule to note: The PI's primary employment (51%+) must be with the awardee company at time of award [VERIFIED FACT]. Twin Synergy Telecommunications is not yet formed; entity formation is a budgeted line (Section E) and an in-progress action.

B. Fringe Benefits [HYPOTHESIS]

Rate: **25% of Senior Personnel** = $0.25 \times 113,750 = \mathbf{\$28,437.50}$

Justification: Covers payroll tax, workers' comp, and minimal health coverage for a two-person startup with no benefits plan in place. No fringe rate has been negotiated or quoted; 25% is a

conservative placeholder, not an offer or a policy [HYPOTHESIS]. Red-pen to confirm before any submission.

C. Equipment [HYPOTHESIS] – modest

Item	Cost
Test routers × 2 @ \$400	\$800
Test terminals (used phones/tablets)	\$1,500
HSM / smartcard USB keys for key ceremonies	\$600
C subtotal	**\$2,900**

Justification: Phase I needs a small lab bench to test onion-service routing and the DID identity prototype against real hardware, not only cloud instances. Equipment is excluded from indirect-cost base (MTDC) under standard practice. Kept deliberately modest — nothing here is a production build-out.

D. Travel [HYPOTHESIS]

Trip	Cost
One technical conference (registration, travel, 3 nights)	\$2,500
One agency visit, Washington DC (travel, 2 nights)	\$1,800
D subtotal	**\$4,300**

Justification: One conference to present Phase I measurement results and recruit technical review; one DC visit for agency engagement. Destinations, conferences, and timing are [HYPOTHESIS] — nothing booked, nothing priced from quotes.

E. Other Direct Costs [HYPOTHESIS]

Item	Cost
Cloud / compute for testnet (12 mo @ \$300/mo)	\$3,600
Legal — entity formation + CALEA counsel consult	\$6,000
Independent security audit of DID prototype + testnet	\$12,000
E subtotal	**\$21,600**

Justification:

- **Cloud/compute:** 12 months of VPS/bandwidth for the \$PP/\$00 testnet and onion-service nodes. \$300/mo is a placeholder scaled from current pricing, not a quote [HYPOTHESIS].
- **Legal:** Entity formation (LLC/C-corp decision still open) plus a paid consult with telecom counsel on the CALEA-compliance engineering line — the compliance lane is counsel's, never ours; this budget buys the questions, not the answers.
- **Security audit:** One independent review of the DID identity prototype and testnet before Phase I closeout. \$12,000 is a placeholder for a small-scope audit, not a bid [HYPOTHESIS].

F. Indirect Costs [HYPOTHESIS]

The company has **no negotiated indirect cost rate** — it does not yet exist.

Approach used here: the **10% de minimis rate** on a Modified Total Direct Cost (MTDC) base [HYPOTHESIS — this is a choice, not a rate the company holds].

- Total direct costs = 113,750 + 28,437.50 + 2,900 + 4,300 + 21,600 = ****\$170,987.50****
- MTDC base = 170,987.50 – 2,900 (equipment excluded) = ****\$168,087.50****
- F subtotal = 0.10 × 168,087.50 = ****\$16,808.75****

Red-pen to confirm: accept de minimis, or state TBD and negotiate with NSF at award.

G. Small Business Fee [HYPOTHESIS]

NSF SBIR permits a small-business fee of **up to 7%** [VERIFIED FACT — current NSF practice].

Fee used here: **5%** of (direct + indirect) — [HYPOTHESIS choice].

- Base = 170,987.50 + 16,808.75 = ****\$187,796.25****
- G subtotal = 0.05 × 187,796.25 = \$9,389.8125 → ****\$9,389.81****

Grand Total

Section	Amount
A. Senior Personnel	\$113,750.00
B. Fringe Benefits	\$28,437.50
C. Equipment	\$2,900.00
D. Travel	\$4,300.00
E. Other Direct Costs	\$21,600.00
F. Indirect Costs	\$16,808.75
G. Small Business Fee	\$9,389.81
TOTAL	**\$197,186.06**

Check: 113,750.00 + 28,437.50 + 2,900.00 + 4,300.00 + 21,600.00 + 16,808.75 + 9,389.81 = **197,186.06 ≤ 305,000 ✓**

Headroom: \$305,000 – \$197,186.06 = **\$107,813.94** unallocated. This is a lean 12-month draft, not a maximal claim. Headroom is deliberate — it can absorb his red-pen additions (higher PI salary basis, longer months, a second engineer, contingency) without breaking the cap.

Notes for his red pen

He must confirm or rule on each of these before this draft touches any real submission:

- ****PI salary basis (\$95,000) and effort (75%)**** — assumed. His call entirely; the 51%+ primary-employment rule is a [VERIFIED FACT] constraint at award.
- ****Second senior hire (\$85,000 @ 50%)**** — assumed. Could be cut, made a consultant line, or converted to subcontract; each changes the indirect base.
- ****Fringe rate (25%)**** — placeholder, not a plan. No benefits plan exists yet.

- ****Indirect approach (10% de minimis)**** — assumed. Alternative: state TBD and negotiate at award. NSF allows either path; pick one before submission.
 - ****Fee rate (5% of 7% max)**** — assumed conservative choice. Could go to 7% or zero.
 - ****12-month duration**** — assumed within the 6–18 month window. Stretching to 18 months changes every monthly line.
 - ****Company formation**** — in progress, not done. Formation cost is budgeted (Section E), and the PI-employment rule bites at award, not at application.
 - ****Equipment/modesty level**** — deliberately lean. If he wants a bigger lab bench, the headroom covers it.
 - ****Conference and DC trip**** — [HYPOTHESIS] travel, nothing booked. Destinations and events TBD by him.
 - ****Security audit scope**** — placeholder bid. Real scope gets defined once the DID prototype exists.
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"Every man and every woman is a star." — Liber AL, I:3